www.tntextbooks.in

Unit 2

Poem

Confessions of a Born Spectator

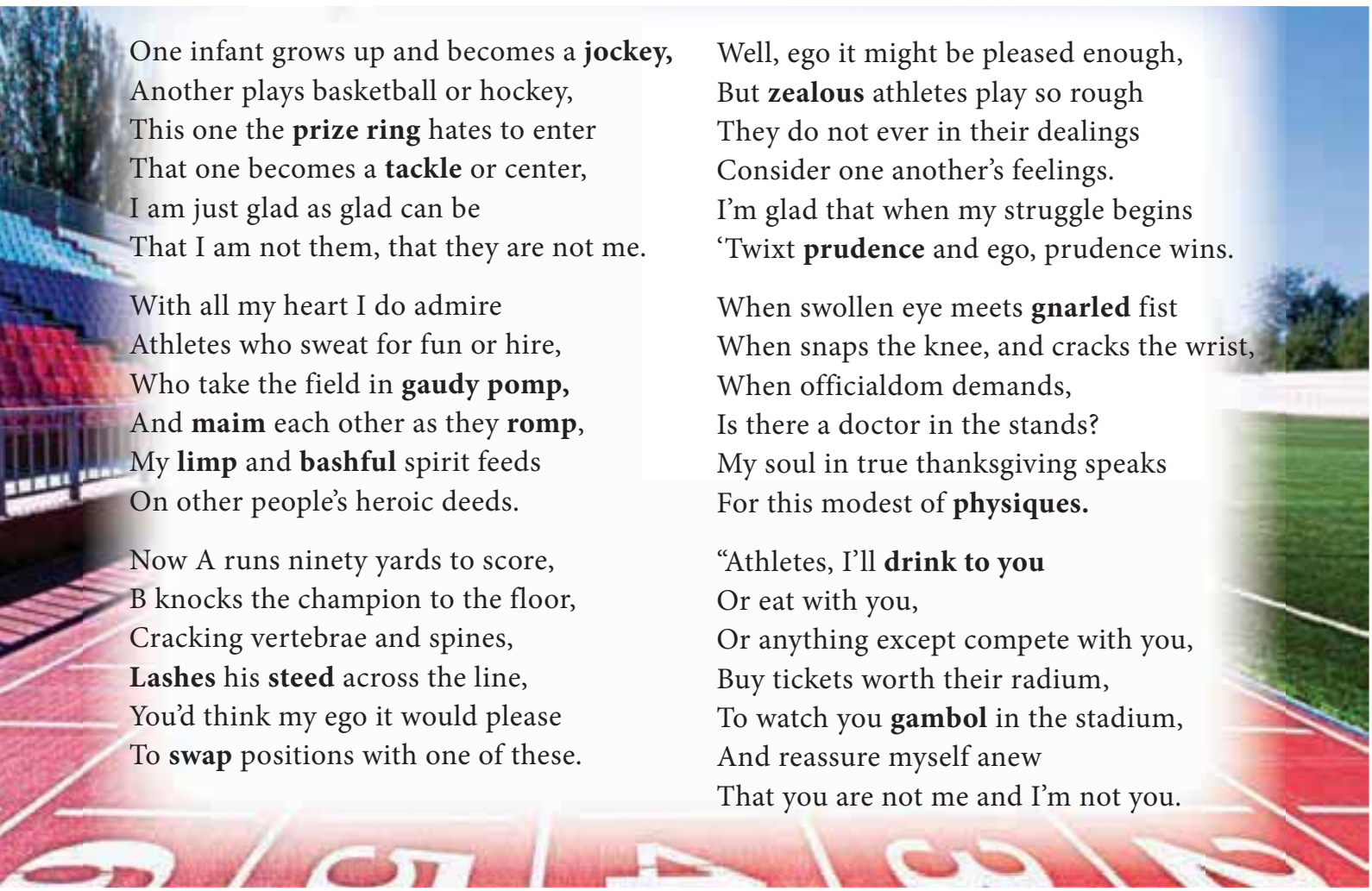
Ogden Nash

Warm Up

Not everybody loves to play and participate in games, sports and other extra-curricular activities. Some of us wish to be mere spectators. List out the activities in which you like to be either a performer or a spectator. Share your views with the class.

Activities		
	performer / player	spectator / audience
e.g.	cricket	magician
a.		
b.		
c.		
d.		
e.		

Here is a poem by Ogden Nash who believes that a spectator can be as enthusiastic as a player. Now let's read and enjoy the poem 'Confessions of a Born Spectator'.



One infant grows up and becomes a **jockey,**
Another plays basketball or hockey,
This one the **prize ring** hates to enter
That one becomes a **tackle** or center,
I am just glad as glad can be
That I am not them, that they are not me.

With all my heart I do admire
Athletes who sweat for fun or hire,
Who take the field in **gaudy pomp,**
And **maim** each other as they **romp**,
My **limp** and **bashful** spirit feeds
On other people's heroic deeds.

Now A runs ninety yards to score,
B knocks the champion to the floor,
Cracking vertebrae and spines,
Lashes his **steed** across the line,
You'd think my ego it would please
To **swap** positions with one of these.

Well, ego it might be pleased enough,
But **zealous** athletes play so rough
They do not ever in their dealings
Consider one another's feelings.
I'm glad that when my struggle begins
'Twixt **prudence** and ego, prudence wins.

When swollen eye meets **gnarled** fist
When snaps the knee, and cracks the wrist,
When officialdom demands,
Is there a doctor in the stands?
My soul in true thanksgiving speaks
For this modest of **physiques.**

"Athletes, I'll **drink to you**
Or eat with you,
Or anything except compete with you,
Buy tickets worth their radium,
To watch you **gambol** in the stadium,
And reassure myself anew
That you are not me and I'm not you.